

HOW CAN ICTs ENHANCE WORK AND LEARNING?

GROUP III



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I- Introduction

Information and Communication Technologies, ICTs refer to all the devices that facilitate the communication between distant people, and the exchange of information and resources all over the world nowadays. They include the Internet, wireless networks like the Wi-Fi(Wireless-Fidelity), cell and smartphones, computers, software, video-conferencing, television, radio, social medias and other medias, applications and services, enabling users to access, retrieve, store, transmit, and manipulate information in a digital form. Today, ICTs are the basis of development on a global scale. In this purpose, they have facilitated, and continue to facilitate work and learning.

II- How can ICTs enhance work?

Across the globe, we are seeing a transformation of the world of work, thanks to information and communication technologies. ICTs are influencing work, both as an industry that creates jobs and as a tool, which facilitate work between workers.

At first glance, ICTs connect people to jobs. Online employment marketplaces are helping an estimated twelve million people worldwide, to find work by connecting them with employers globally. 'Babajob' in India, 'Duma' and 'M-Kazi' in Kenya and 'Souktel' in the Middle East and North Africa are some examples. This is possible thanks to professional social networks such as 'LinkedIn', 'XING', 'Viadeo' who give opportunities to unemployed, to display their resume, search for jobs and enhance their professional reputation by posting updates; all this in order to attract employers, not only in restrict arrears, but all over the world. And this allows reciprocally employers, to find many qualified applications all over the world in the purpose of having selective employers, and enhancing qualified work in their enterprises.

At second glance, ICTs promote distant work and facilitate work in firms. In fact, thanks to video-conferencing, the employers of an organisation can continue to communicate with others, even when there are separated by km and km. This service is ensured by applications such as 'Zoom', 'Skype', 'Google meet'. For example, this new way of working became very famous the previous year, due to the containment imposed by the Covid19 pandemic. Moreover, nowadays, computers are present in all the organisations, because they offer the opportunity to treat, store and share all over the world rapidly and effectively, the information; and so, they ease work in enterprises and boost their development.

III- How can ICTs enhance learning?

Improving learning is a critical issue, particularly at a time of educational expansion. ICTs can enhance apprenticeship in several ways.

To start ICTs Motivate and ease learning. In fact, ICTs such as videos, television and multimedia computer software, that combine text, sound, and colorful moving images, are very attractive, and so are used today, to delivers didactic contents. At this level, we have didactic and attractive TV channels such as 'Science&VieTV', 'National Geography Channel ', 'Plannète et Vie', and also YouTube channels like 'Scienceclic', 'MindYourDecision' and 'Deux gouttes de Culture', which educate students with beautiful video contents. Furthermore, thanks to internet service known as 'Web', students can deepen and even complete the courses given in classes. Thereby, through search engines like 'Yahoo', 'Bing' and 'Google', this internet platform develops in learners the spirit of research, and offers them freely, the greatest world virtual library known as the Net.

In addition, ICTs enhance learning, by allowing distant group work. In fact, through Chats and Forums, students can study online with their classmates and teachers; meaning that they have the possibility to expose their preoccupations and have solutions staying at home, and solve others difficulties. This is possible thanks to social networks such as 'Facebook', 'WhatsApp', 'Telegram' and even Websites Forums like 'Futurascience' and 'Openclassrooms' where students and teachers can form study groups; and by this way, continue studying even not in school.

IV- Conclusion

In short, Information and Communication Technologies are revolutionary devices, which have transformed the world of today. As we realised upstream, they enhance both work and learning in organisations and schools. However, like every human creation, they have some drawbacks when they are not well used especially by the youth: They can be tools of bad distraction, laziness and divert learners from the right path. In the domain of learning, it is then up to parents, not only to give ICTs gadgets(Phones, computers...) to mature children, but also to inspect the activity of their offspring online regularly, through the 'Parental Control' option, present on all these gadgets